Narrative Engine - Dialogue & Story System

Visual novel narrative dialogue system for Unity with node-based editor

KMA Dialogue System is a complete narrative tool for Unity that helps you build interactive dialogues with branching choices - plus saving and rollback to return to previous decisions.

Create clean, game-ready dialogue UI for both **PC and mobile**, drive scene/background changes directly from the dialogue flow, and ship story interactions faster with a demo scene included.

Perfect for indie teams and commercial projects that need narrative features without overcomplicated setup.

💬 KMA Dialogue System - Core Capabilities

🧩 Visual Dialogue Builder (Nodes & Branches)

Build dialogues as a clear node-based flow: lines, choices, transitions, and progression logic - organized and easy to maintain.

🔀 Branching Choices

Choice buttons appear only when the story requires them, keeping the UI clean and focused on decisions.

💾 Dialogue Checkpoints, Saving & Rollback

Set up checkpoints, saving, and rollback behavior directly inside the dialogue flow - ideal for “your choices matter” scenarios and replayable story moments.

🖥️📱 PC + Mobile UI Layouts

Included layouts for **PC and mobile**:

- dialogue window size adapts to text length;
- speaker nameplates and portraits appear based on who is currently speaking.

🏞️ Scene / Background Switching from Dialogue

Trigger scene or background changes directly from dialogue nodes to keep narrative moments dynamic and visually clear.

🧪 Demo Scene Included

A complete demo scene that showcases all core mechanics of the asset.

🎮 Best Fit Genres

KMA Dialogue System shines in games where story, choices, and character-driven delivery matter - the kind of dialogue experience players recognize from many popular titles:

✅ **RPG / Action RPG** - NPC conversations and dialogue-driven progression in the spirit of *Mass Effect*, *The Witcher 3*, *Baldur's Gate 3*;

✅ **Adventure / Story-driven games** - cinematic dialogue scenes and narrative pacing similar to *Life is Strange*, *The Walking Dead* (Telltale), *Oxenfree*;

✅ **Visual Novel / Interactive Fiction** - choice moments with controlled story progression, as seen in *Steins;Gate*, *Doki Doki Literature Club!*, *Phoenix Wright: Ace Attorney*;

✅ **Detective / Mystery** - interrogation-style conversations and clue-driven dialogue paths like *Pentiment*, *L.A. Noire*, *Ace Attorney*, *Disco Elysium*;

✅ **Survival / Horror** - narrative events and decision pressure with dialogue beats like *Until Dawn*, *The Quarry*, *The Dark Pictures Anthology*;

✅ **Strategy / City-builder** - advisor/event dialogues and story modules in the tone of *Frostpunk*, *This War of Mine*;

✅ **Roguelite / Roguelike** - hub conversations and repeatable narrative beats similar to *Hades* and *Cult of the Lamb*;

✅ **Casual / Narrative (PC + mobile)** - short-session dialogue-first experiences in the style of *Choices: Stories You Play*, *Episode*, *Romance Club*;

✅ **Educational / Serious games** - scenario-based dialogues and decision-driven training simulations.

⭐ Why Choose KMA Dialogue System?

Because it's more than a dialogue box - it's a practical **narrative-building workflow** with the essentials: **branching, checkpoints, saving, and rollback**, backed by a demo that shows it instantly. Less boilerplate, more storytelling.

🔗 Additional Resources

- 🌐 Website
- 💬 Discord Community
- 🖼 Demo

Requirements & Dependencies

Unity Version

- **Unity 6000.3 or newer** is recommended
- Earlier versions are not officially supported

Required Dependencies

UniTask (Required)

This asset uses **UniTask** for asynchronous operations and internal task handling.

UniTask is **required** for the asset to function correctly.

Installation steps:

1. Open **Unity Package Manager**
2. Click **"+" → Add package from git URL**
3. Paste:

```
https://github.com/Cysharp/UniTask.git?path=src/UniTask/Assets/Plugins/UniTask
```

1. Install the package and wait for compilation to complete

> If UniTask is already installed in your project, no additional action is required.

Optional Dependencies

TextMeshPro (Samples Only)

Sample scenes and example UI included with this asset use **TextMeshPro**.

TextMeshPro is **not required** for the core framework functionality.

Installation steps:

1. Open **Unity Package Manager**
2. Locate **TextMeshPro** in the Unity Registry
3. Install the package if it is not already installed
4. Import **TMP Essential Resources** when prompted

> You may safely remove sample content if you do not want to include TextMeshPro in your project.

Render Pipelines

The framework is compatible with:

- Built-in Render Pipeline
- URP
- HDRP

Quick Setup (5-Minute Setup)

This section walks you through setting up **KMA SoundCore Toolkit** in a new project in under five minutes using the built-in **Setup Wizard**.

No manual configuration or coding is required.

Step 1 — Import the Asset

1. Import the Asset

After purchasing or downloading:

```
Assets → Import Package → Custom Package
```

2. Open the Demo Scene (Recommended First Step)

3. Press “Play”.

You now already have:

- Dialogue flow
- Choices
- UI
- Rollback
- Saving logic

Working out of the box ✅

Basic Usage

Narrative Engine uses **GUID-based configurations**, allowing you to safely use characters and backgrounds inside dialogues without scene dependencies or hard references.

Below is the full workflow.

👤 Adding & Editing Actors

All characters are stored inside:

```
ActorsInfoConfig (ScriptableObject)
```

➕ How to Add a New Actor

1. Open:

```
Assets → Create → KMA → Actors Info Config
```

(or open an existing one: Tools → KissMyAssets → Visual Novel Core → Actors Config)

2. In the Inspector you will see the Actor Entries list.

Click:

```
Add Entry
```

The system will automatically:

✅ Generate a unique GUID
✅ Create a new ActorInfo

💡 Important

Dialogues reference Actors via GUID, not by name.

So:

✔ Renaming is safe
❗ Deleting may break existing dialogue usage

🏞️ Adding & Editing Backgrounds

Backgrounds work similarly, but use a custom editor UI.

➕ Creating a Background

Open:

```
Assets → Create → KMA → Backgrounds Info Config
```

(or open an existing one: Tools → KissMyAssets → Visual Novel Core → Backgrounds Config)

Click:

```
Add Entry
```

🧠 How They Are Used in Dialogues

Actors and Backgrounds automatically appear in:

- Replica nodes
- Choice nodes
- Branch nodes

as dropdown selections.

🗨️ Creating a Dialogue

1. Open Dialogue Builder

```
Tools → KissMyAssets → Visual Novel Core → Dialogue Builder
```

---

2. Create a New Dialogue Scene

Enter:

```
Asset Name → Create Dialogue Scene Asset
```

The scene will appear in the list below.

3. Building the Dialogue

Inside the Node Editor:

Create Nodes

Select Node Type:

- Start
- Replica
- Choice
- Branching

- Choice Replica
- End

Then click:

```
Create
```

4. Replica Node

Allows you to:

- choose Background
- add Actors
- define:

```
Left / Right
Day / Night
Speaker
```

and set dialogue text.

5. Choice Node

Adds decision points:

```
+ Add option
```

Each option creates its own branch.

6. Connecting Nodes

Drag output → input between nodes to create dialogue flow:

```
Start → Replica → Choice → Replica → End
```

📌 Best Practice

Recommended workflow:

1. Create Actors first
2. Then Backgrounds
3. Then Dialogues

This ensures smooth narrative flow without rework.

FAQ & Troubleshooting

❓ Why don't my Actors appear in dialogue nodes?

Make sure:

- The Actor exists in **ActorsInfoConfig**
- The config asset is assigned in your Narrative setup (if required by your project architecture)
- The entry was not deleted after being used in dialogue

If you just added a new Actor:

👉 Try reopening the Dialogue Scene or refreshing the editor.

❓ Why don't my Backgrounds appear in Replica nodes?

Check:

- Background is added in **BackgroundsInfoConfig**
- Sprite is assigned
- Asset was saved after editing

If still missing:

👉 Reopen Dialogue Builder or click **Refresh List**

❓ Can I rename Actors or Backgrounds?

Yes ✅

Since dialogues use **GUID references**, renaming:

✔ does NOT break dialogues
✔ does NOT affect existing scenes

❓ What breaks dialogues?

Deleting:

- Actor entries
- Background entries

will break nodes that reference them.

Best practice:

⚠️ Avoid deleting entries after dialogues are built
✔ Rename instead

🧠 Dialogue Builder Issues

❗ I created a Dialogue Scene but it doesn't open

Try:

- Double-clicking the asset
- Or using **Ping → Open**

If it still doesn't open:

✔ Ensure no compile errors exist
✔ Restart Unity editor

❗ Node connections are not working

Make sure:

- You connect **output → input**
- Start node exists
- Flow eventually reaches an End node

Broken flows may result in dialogue not starting.

❗ Dialogue doesn't start in Play Mode

Check:

- Dialogue Trigger exists in scene
- Dialogue Scene asset is assigned
- Start node is present
- Nodes are connected

Also verify:

👉 Game is not paused
👉 No missing references in Console

❗ Choice buttons do not appear

This usually means:

- Flow never reaches a Choice node
- Choice node has no options

Check:

✔ Node connections
✔ At least one option exists